Kalbi marinade

Roy Choi's sweet soy, orange and kiwi marinade for Korean short ribs

Makes about 2 litres (8 cups) · **Prep** 15 min · Adapted from masterclass.com

Kiwi does the tenderising here: its enzymes break down the meat fast, so don't leave short ribs in it for more than a day or they turn mushy.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 large onion, peeled and roughly chopped
- About 140 g (1 cup) peeled garlic cloves
- 1 bunch scallions (about 8), roughly chopped
- 5 tbsp toasted sesame seeds
- 200 g (1 cup) sugar
- 2 large kiwifruits
- 500 ml (2 cups) soy sauce
- 250 ml (1 cup) mirin, apple juice or water
- 500 ml (2 cups) fresh orange juice
- 250 ml (1 cup) toasted sesame oil

METHOD

1. **Load the blender.** Put the onion, garlic, scallions, sesame seeds and sugar in the blender jar.
2. **Add the kiwi.** Halve the kiwifruits, scoop the flesh into the jar and discard the skins.
3. **Blend.** Pour in the soy sauce, mirin, orange juice and sesame oil. Blend on high for about 10 seconds, until smooth.
4. **Marinate.** Use about 500 ml (2 cups) for 1.8 kg (4 lb) flanken-cut short ribs, sliced 1 cm (½ in) thick. Massage it into the meat and refrigerate for at least 2 hours and up to 1 day.
5. **Grill.** Lift the ribs out of the marinade and grill over medium-high heat, about 4 minutes a side, until charred at the edges.

NOTES

- The batch is big: one blender jar makes enough for four rounds of short ribs. Keep the unused marinade in a sealed jar in the fridge for up to a week, or halve the recipe.
- Never reuse marinade that has had raw meat in it.
- It also works for pork shoulder, chicken thighs and thinly sliced rib-eye (bulgogi).